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China Insurance

China's ageing demographics create pension upside for China Life and AMP

China Life's positive profit alert ([link](#)) was not well perceived by the market (H-share: -3% vs. HSI: +3%), seemingly due to reduced confidence in interim dividend upside, as this is the second year of the interim dividend proposal. China Life-H's valuation looks undemanding at 4x FY27E P/E, with a 4% yield. As we move into the 1H reporting season in August, we believe an interim dividend hike, double-digit life sales momentum and a robust capital position should support an attractive risk-reward profile for the stock. Beyond near-term catalysts, China Life is well positioned for long-term upside from China's ageing demographics and pension market growth. China Life Pension Co., Ltd., or CLPC, is China Life's exclusive pension management platform. China Life holds a 70.74% controlling stake, while AMP remains the second-largest shareholder, with a stable 19.99% strategic stake since 2014. We see China's ageing population, policy support for longevity solutions and low pension asset penetration versus other ageing economies as a favourable long-term backdrop for CLPC, with positive read-across to AMP's earnings outlook. We are OW on both stocks.

- **Three-pillar system shifts towards private pension growth.** China's pension system comprises Pillar 1 government basic pensions, Pillar 2 enterprise and occupational annuities, and Pillar 3 tax-incentivised individual pensions. While the system has historically been led by government and corporate schemes, Pillar 3 has accelerated following tax incentives for individual pension products. As of Dec-24, the three pillars' AUM were Rmb11.6T (US\$1.7T), Rmb6.8T (US\$1.0T) and Rmb182B (US\$26B), respectively.
- **CLPC leads across the pension value chain.** CLPC is one of the few platforms with full licenses across China's three-pillar system and is a leading national pension asset manager. As of end-2025, it managed nearly Rmb2.4T of pension assets, including Rmb78B in Pillar 1, Rmb2.2T in Pillar 2, where it ranks No.1, and Rmb76B in Pillar 3. It also offers group insurance and employee benefit solutions, giving it exposure to both institutional and individual pension demand. Pension assets account for only 13.8% of China's 2024 GDP, versus an average 42.5% among OECD countries ([link](#)), pointing to significant long-term growth potential. CLPC reported a core solvency ratio of 1,023% as of Mar-26, 2025 net profit of Rmb1.7B, up 39% oya, and total assets, liabilities and shareholders' equity of Rmb91.6B, Rmb82.1B and Rmb9.5B, respectively. In 2025, CLPC contributed roughly 1.1% of China Life's net profit.
- **AMP.** AMP today provided updated earnings for 1H26 – which suggested NPAT upgrades on consensus of ~ 25% - which appears in large part to be driven by substantial upside surprise on the trends in their 19.99% stake in CLPC. This business reported A\$56m in NPAT in 1H26, up 24% hoh. We remind that this business grew 66% hoh in 2H25, and CY25 was up 53% on CY24. AMP had also previously indicated that AUM had grown to Rmb2.05T in CY24 (up 24%) vs. the pcg, suggesting growth in closing FUM and operating leverage was likely the driver of earnings in FY25.

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[China Insurance: What If: Simulating Upside if China Pensions Are Fully-Opened](#), 25 November 2022

[China Insurance: Rethinking retirement: Solutions for an ageing society](#), 22 June 2022

Table 1: China Insurance: comps table

Local currency, %, x

Company	B'berg Code	Rating	Price (16-Jul-2026)	PT (Dec-26)	Upside/downside	P/E 26e	P/E 27e	P/BV 26e	P/BV 27e
China Life-H	2628 HK Equity	OW	27.7	40.0	44%	5	4	1.1	1.0
China Life-A	601628 CH Equity	N	38.9	39.0	0%	19	17	1.7	1.6
Ping An-H	2318 HK Equity	OW	54.8	90.0	64%	6	6	0.8	0.7
Ping An-A	601318 CH Equity	OW	50.7	83.0	64%	7	6	0.8	0.7
CPIC-H	2601 HK Equity	OW	28.6	43.0	50%	6	6	0.7	0.6
CPIC-A	601601 CH Equity	OW	31.0	50.0	61%	7	7	0.8	0.8
New China Life-H	1336 HK Equity	N	46.8	45.0	-4%	5	5	1.0	0.9
New China Life-A	601336 CH Equity	N	64.4	59.0	-8%	9	8	1.6	1.5
PICC Group-H	1339 HK Equity	N	5.1	5.8	13%	5	5	0.4	0.4
PICC Group-A	601319 CH Equity	N	7.3	6.9	-5%	11	9	1.1	1.0
PICC P&C	2328 HK Equity	N	14.3	14.0	-2%	8	7	1.0	1.0

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates.

Snapshot on China's pension market

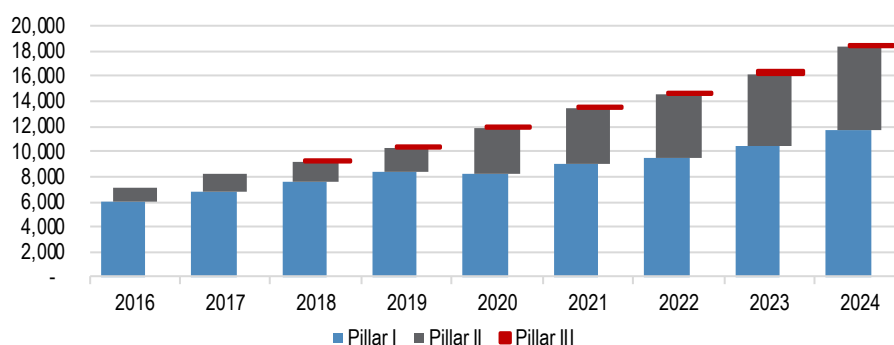
China's pension system is based on three pillars - government basis (Urban/Rural basic pension), corporate (Enterprise/Occupation Annuity), and individual pension with tax incentives. In the past decade, the underlying structure of pension system fell much on government-dominated and corporate pension categories (AUM of three pillars: US\$1.7T/1.0T/26B as of Dec-24). The China government first officially mentioned the pension sector in the 14th Five-Year Plan (2021 to 2025) in March 2021 including "build a pension service industry that balances between commercial and social value". Hence, the Chinese government has conducted a series of pension reforms including the facilitation of the private pension business, allowing insurers, banks and wealth management firms to offer individual retirement. That said, the authority is aiming to address the looming shortfall in the private pension pillar and alleviate the high dependence on the first/second pillar as early as possible. In March 2026, the Chinese government newly announced the 15th Five-Year Plan (2026 to 2030), outlining that it shall prioritize to improve a comprehensive multi-tier pension insurance system, including expanding the coverage of corporate pension, refining supportive policies for individual pension alongside vigorously developing commercial pension insurance. By 2030, the government targets a combined AUM scale of enterprises and Occupation Annuity nationwide exceeding Rmb9T (~US\$1.3T).

- **First Pillar (AUM: Rmb11.6T or US\$1.7T, as of Dec-24).** The composition of the first pillar included government-run basic pension Fund and National Social Security Fund. According to the Statistical bulletin on the development of Human Resources and Social Security in 2024 ([link](#)), the ending balance of the basic pension fund as of Dec-24 was Rmb8.7T. The other substantial supplement to this pillar is the National Social Security Fund (NSSF 全国社保基金). It worked as a reserve fund in case deficit of basic pension occurred. As of 2024, the net assets of NSSF were at Rmb2.9T, according to the annual report of the National Council for Social Security Fund ([link](#)).
- **Second Pillar (AUM: Rmb6.8T or US\$1.0T, as of Dec-24).** Enterprise annuity and occupation annuity are fundamental elements of the second pillar. Based on the annual report disclosure from the Ministry of Human Resource and Social Security, the total AUM for corporate pension is Rmb 6.8T, as of Dec-24 ([link](#)), comprising approximately ~Rmb3.7T of enterprise annuity and Rmb3.1T of occupation annuity.

- Third Pillar (AUM: Rmb182B or US\$26B, as of Dec-24):** Supported by ongoing government policies, China's pillar 3 pension AUM has grown at 137% CAGR from 2020 to 2024, up to Rmb182B, according to China Construction Bank's pension finance white paper (2025). Over the past decade, China's pension system has remained heavily skewed towards government-led categories. Following pilot programmes for individual pension schemes, including tax-deferred commercial endowment insurance and pension target funds, the State Council initially proposed a private pension plan with tax incentives in April-2022. The plan encourages individuals to set up personal pension accounts, with current annual contributions of up to Rmb12,000, or approximately US\$1,717, as of July-26. Overall, the Chinese government is gradually building a multi-layered, multi-pillar pension system.

Figure 1: China: Asset scale of pillars under the pension system

Rmb in billion



Source: Ministry of Human Resources and Social Security, National Council for Social Security Fund, China Construction Bank's Pension Finance white paper (2025).

Table 2: China Life Pension Company: Overview of key figures

Rmb in million, %, %p

Shareholders structure	2024	2025	Y/Y	1Q26	Q/Q
China Life	78.68%	78.68%	0.0%	78.68%	0.0%
China Life Insurance Company	70.74%	70.74%	0.0%	70.74%	0.0%
China Life Insurance (Group)	4.41%	4.41%	0.0%	4.41%	0.0%
China Life Asset Management	3.53%	3.53%	0.0%	3.53%	0.0%
China Chengtong Trust	1.33%	1.33%	0.0%	1.33%	0.0%
AMP Australia	19.99%	19.99%	0.0%	19.99%	0.0%
Operational metrics	2024	2025	Y/Y	1Q26	Q/Q
Core solvency ratio	1057%	1033%	-24%p	1023%	-11%p
Comprehensive solvency ratio	1075%	1053%	-22%p	1041%	-12%p
Net profit (Rmb in million)	1,246	1,736	39%	711	N.A.
Total assets (Rmb in million)	60,802	91,571	51%	100,683	10%
Total liabilities (Rmb in million)	52,618	82,103	56%	90,588	10%
Total shareholder equity (Rmb in million)	8,184	9,468	16%	10,095	7%

Source: China Life Pension Company (CLPC), 2025/2024 annual report and 1Q26 solvency report.

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 16 July 2026, unless otherwise indicated)

AMP Limited(AMP.AX/A\$1.90/OW), China Life Insurance - H(2628.HK/HK\$27.70/OW)

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Date	Rating	Price (A\$)	Price Target (A\$)
07-Aug-23	N	1.10	1.05
11-Aug-23	N	1.15	1.13
18-Oct-23	N	1.14	1
16-Nov-23	N	1.02	0.9
23-Nov-23	N	0.85	0.94
03-Jan-24	N	0.93	1.04
18-Apr-24	N	1.14	1.1
05-Aug-24	N	1.18	1.2
09-Aug-24	N	1.28	1.3
03-Oct-24	N	1.32	1.35
13-Jan-25	N	1.60	1.47
06-Feb-25	N	1.73	1.6
15-Feb-25	N	1.49	1.5
18-Apr-25	OW	1.14	1.35
07-Jul-25	OW	1.42	1.4
22-Jul-25	N	1.68	1.55
07-Aug-25	N	1.67	1.65
13-Oct-25	N	1.67	1.7
16-Oct-25	N	1.76	1.8
30-Jan-26	N	1.64	1.7
13-Feb-26	OW	1.28	1.5
27-Mar-26	OW	1.27	1.45
30-Mar-26	OW	1.25	1.5
30-Jun-26	OW	1.55	1.75

China Life Insurance - H (2628.HK, 2628 HK) Price Chart



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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Date	Rating	Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)
22-Aug-23	OW	11.12	18
28-Dec-23	OW	9.77	15
10-Sep-24	OW	11.22	17
13-Oct-24	OW	16.46	22
09-Jan-25	UW	13.84	10
15-Apr-25	UW	13.66	9
25-Jul-25	OW	22.35	31
07-Jan-26	OW	31.10	40

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